PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Mitsubishi Delica Space Gear

1994–2007 · L400 · PD6W · PE8W · PD8W

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Crawl under it with a flashlight**
  Rust is the van-killer. One Delica Canada owner photographed it on the frame rails, under the battery compartment, in the hole in front of the battery tray, along the seam back to the firewall and behind the rear bumper where the spare sat. Another warned that rebuilding a rotten L400 cost so much time and money he'd never do it again.
- [ ] **Look up, too**
  Owners warn about the roof and the windshield surround. Crystal Lite Roof vans are said to be prone to rust and electrical problems, and one owner was quoted about $1,000 for windshield-frame rust repair.
- [ ] **Confirm it's actually 4WD**
  Rear-drive Space Gears exist (PA, PB and PC codes). A 4WD van has a Super Select lever and a chassis code such as PD6W, PE8W, PD8W, PF6W or PF8W. Match the code on the frame number to the engine before you pay.
- [ ] **Cycle the Super Select**
  Shift through 2H, 4H, 4HLc and 4LLc on loose ground. A front-wheel light that keeps flashing usually means a sticking vacuum solenoid pair or a seized front-diff actuator; a flashing centre-diff light points to the transfer-case position switches.
- [ ] **Cold-start a diesel yourself**
  Arrive early so the seller can't pre-warm it. Hard starting points to glow plugs or the glow-plug controller, and smoke can be a clogged EGR, injectors or an injection pump that's on its way out. The early mechanical pump is the one owners say leaks.
- [ ] **Check the cooling system and head**
  An owner told Field Mag that overheating and cracked heads are common on L400s. Look for coolant loss, bubbles in the reservoir and white smoke, and ask whether the van has ever overheated. A Delica Canada member advises crack-testing the head if the gasket has gone.
- [ ] **Test the automatic properly**
  Drive it until it's warm and make sure it shifts through all four gears. A van that holds third and flashes the neutral light has dropped into limp mode, which can be a sensor fault or a failing transmission.
- [ ] **Ask how it got here**
  Get the export certificate, the import paperwork and the build month. In the US the 25-year clock starts at the build date, and RHD insurance and registration rules vary by state and province.

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **Chassis code**
  4WD wagons include PD4W (2.4 petrol), PD6W (3.0 V6), PD8W and PE8W (2.8 diesel) and the long-wheelbase PF6W and PF8W. Rear-drive codes include PA4W (2.4), PA5W (2.5 diesel) and PB6W (3.0 LWB). Bring a Trailer listings show frame numbers such as PD6W0400925 and PE8W0600311.
- [ ] **Type-code prefix**
  Japanese papers show prefixes such as E-, KD-, KH-, GF- and GH- in front of the chassis code (for example KH-PE8W or GH-PD6W). JDMBUYSELL explains these as emissions-regulation markers, so they help date a van.
- [ ] **Series 1 vs Series 2**
  Series 1 vans (1994–mid-1997) have the three-section bull-bar front; Series 2 vans have a moulded bumper and revised lights. Diesel Series 2 vans have the electronically controlled injection pump, which matters when it needs work.
- [ ] **Is it really 4WD?**
  Look for the Super Select lever and display. On the Delica Canada forum, a member ordering lower ball joints was twice sent a 2WD-type joint, and the factory manual shows the 2WD and 4WD joints mounting differently, so check the code before you buy the van or its parts.
- [ ] **Roof**
  Grades came with an Aero Roof (about 1,965 mm tall on SWB 4WD), High Roof (2,060 mm), twin sunroofs or the glass Crystal Lite Roof; long-wheelbase Crystal Lite vans are 2,070 mm tall. Check roof height before you buy for a garage or a roof-top tent.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/delica/delica-space-gear/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks